

Danny Valenzuela

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Senior Data Engineer | Data Architect | Database Administrator

Innovative and results-driven Senior Data Engineer with 25+ years of experience leading database and data engineering initiatives across financial, staffing, and consulting sectors. Adept at designing scalable data architectures, automating workflows, managing enterprise-level data warehouses, and leading cross-functional teams. Recognized for technical versatility, business insight, and commitment to delivering high-quality data solutions that drive informed decision-making.

Core Skills

Cloud & Data Platforms: Microsoft Fabric • Azure Synapse • OneLake • Azure SQL

ETL / Integration: Azure Data Factory • SSIS • PySpark • PowerShell • API Integration

Data Architecture: Data Modeling • Lakehouse • Dimensional Design • Governance

Reporting: Power BI • SSRS • Dataflows • DAX • Data Visualization

Programming: Python • SQL • T-SQL • VB.NET • ASP.NET

DevOps: Azure DevOps • Git • CI/CD • DataOps • Automation

Professional Experience

Senior Data Engineer / Architect / Manager

Advanced Group – Chicago, IL | Jun 2020 – Jul 2025

- Architected and launched company's first enterprise Data Warehouse and Lakehouse using Microsoft Fabric and OneLake, integrating data sources and accelerating analytics delivery by 65%.
- Built and automated ETL pipelines in Azure Data Factory, Python and PySpark, reducing manual data prep by 80%.
- Standardized data models across Finance, HR, and Operations, improving reporting accuracy by 30%.
- Designed and implemented Medallion architecture (Bronze, Silver, Gold) on Microsoft Fabric Lakehouse and OneLake, enabling scalable ingestion, standardized transformations, and analytics-ready data models.
- Designed Power BI datasets used by business users, enabling self-service analytics and faster decision cycles.
- Implemented CI/CD in Azure DevOps for ADF deployments, ensuring version control and zero-downtime releases.

Senior Database Administrator / Developer

Payroc – Chicago, IL | Oct 2018 – Jun 2020

- Established the company's first dedicated DBA function, improving database uptime, scalability, and data consistency across production and development systems.
- Automated ETL workflows using SSIS, PowerShell and Python to process large financial datasets, reducing reporting turnaround time by 70%.
- Enhanced performance monitoring with custom alerting scripts, cutting issue resolution time by 50% and preventing data loss incidents.

- Implemented data backup and recovery plans aligned with compliance requirements, achieving 100% backup success rates.
- Collaborated with business stakeholders to design optimized stored procedures and analytical views, improving reporting accuracy and financial forecasting.

Senior DBA / Report Developer

RGP (Accretive Solutions) – Chicago, IL / Jun 2013 – Sep 2018

- Solely managed enterprise-wide SQL Server and reporting infrastructure supporting multiple business applications.
- Developed and deployed 100+ SSRS dashboards and KPIs, giving leadership real-time visibility into revenue and operational performance.
- Re-engineered ETL pipelines integrating Bullhorn and Dynamics GP via SSIS, decreasing data latency by 90%.
- Created automated .NET dashboards to track job performance and system health, reducing manual report validation by 75%.
- Optimized T-SQL queries and indexes, reducing average report execution times by up to 60% while improving end-user experience.

Database Developer (Consultant)

US Cellular via KForce, Bensenville, IL / Dec 2012 – Jun 2013

- Designed and deployed a SQL Server asset management and licensing database supporting the Windows 7 migration for 3,000+ devices.
- Created a web-based interface using ASP.NET and SSRS for scheduling upgrades and tracking hardware lifecycles.

Data Architect (Consultant)

TTX via Apex Systems, Chicago, IL / May 2012 – Aug 2012

- Conducted an enterprise database access audit across 50+ SQL Server instances and implemented standardized permissions and policies to ensure security compliance.

Front Office Developer

Newedge Group (Fimat), Chicago, IL / Feb 2007 – Mar 2012

- Captured and normalized high-volume trade data via FIX protocol; maintained F&O data warehouse.
- Automated compliance reporting using Python, SQL, Oracle, and Crystal Reports.

*Additional experience available upon request or on full resume. *

Education

M.S. in Computer Studies, DePaul University – Chicago, IL

B.A. in Arts & Communication / Computer Graphics, Columbia College – Chicago, IL

Certifications and Tools

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Engineer Associate (DP-203) (In progress)
- Microsoft Fabric
- Workato Automation Pro Certification

Additional Information

- Experienced in Agile, DataOps, and cloud migration frameworks.

- Strong communication and cross-team leadership skills.
- Marathon coach and finisher of 26 full marathons – proven perseverance and discipline.